

## OREGON CITY COURIER

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## THE COUNTY POOR

Some weeks ago the Courier made some comment on the way money was being dispersed to the "indigent poor." The matter was brought to this paper's attention by the statement of Linn E. Jones, then mayor of the county seat, who said that Oregon City had passed through the Christmas season last year without having any dependent poor asking municipal aid. Following that it developed that the county court was paying allowances to some people in the county seat who seemed to be undeserving of public charity.

The Courier's publication of details of certain cases on the county bounty list evidently stirred up somebody. For shortly after it was printed there was a slight pruning of the county allowances, and some people who had been getting public funds were notified that they wouldn't get them any more. This happened at about the same time that the county court announced its plan of utilizing the old county fair grounds near Canby for a county poor farm.

The Courier believes that there were a number of people getting county aid that should not have been so favored. But there were also a number of deserving cases. When there is no county poor farm, to which paupers and those unable to care for themselves can be sent, it is hard to differentiate between worthy cases and those in which people are simply lazy. When the county has a poor farm there will not be this difficulty, for folk who are not in actual need will balk at going to the poor house. And if they don't balk, and are taken there, they will at least do some work for their keep.

Last week the Courier's attention was called to a case that appears, upon investigation, to be a deserving one. A woman, blind and bedridden part of the time, has two children for whom she is caring. Up to the present she had been allowed by the county court fifteen dollars a month as a mother's pension. Following the investigation into the county expenditures for the poor, she was notified that her fifteen dollars would cease. In order to pay her household expenses this woman knits hammocks and things, and gives "readings." About the only "luxury" she has in her home is a telephone, and under the circumstances a telephone in her case is pretty nearly a necessity.

Any woman who is blind and who is limited as to her means of earning her living on account of illness, and who is trying to bring up two children, would appear to be worthy of county aid. The Courier hopes that the county court will reconsider its action in this particular case, and that at least some of the former county aid will be continued to this woman. There are other cases where cutting off the county aid could be far better be done, and the Courier hasn't heard that it has been stopped in some of these other and less deserving cases.

## THE BIG BROTHERHOOD

The Courier's faith in the brotherhood of man was considerably strengthened last week. And it was a simple little thing like a funeral that did the strengthening.

The funeral was held because quite a number of county seat folk felt that they owed a duty to every man, no matter what his estate, and that part of this duty was seeing that every man had a decent burial. Maybe you've always thought that everybody would chip in and see that a man was given a final resting place—but it appears that some people don't feel that way about it.

However, because there are some fine spirited men in the county seat, the remains of James Hayek, who was burned to death at Highland last January, were recently buried last week in Mountain View cemetery. Elsewhere in these columns will be found a news story of that funeral—perhaps the most remarkable funeral ever held in Oregon City. Right here, however, The Courier wishes to

extend its thanks to those of its friends who made it possible for the remains of the unfortunate man to have the sort of a funeral that was held.

James Hayek was nothing to these men. They didn't know him, and until he died they didn't know that he had ever lived. But when they heard the facts in his case, and the odd circumstances regarding his death, they felt that something ought to be done about it—something more than just putting the poor remains in a hole in the pauper's plot. Maybe they felt that they ought to do something a little bit extra to wipe out the stain on the county's honor when James Hayek's bones were raked into a hole under the ruins of his burned home, and left there like the bones of a dog. Maybe they felt that the brotherhood of man was something more than a theory; that it was something that ought to be applied in every day life.

In any event they dug down into their jeans willingly and made up a modest purse, so that James Hayek could have a funeral that was just a little more than the law required. The men didn't give much in coin of the realm—they were not asked to—but they gave a great deal in spirit. They gave something for a dead stranger; they gave when they knew that the stranger wouldn't even be able to appreciate it—at least in this world. The Courier merely stated the circumstances of the case to these men, and without hesitation they said: "Sure, I want to do something." There wasn't any "grand-standing" about it; they didn't even know that the Courier was going to say anything about it. But something fine within them made them feel that they ought to do something, and they did it.

The men who contributed to the fund that made it possible for James Hayek to have a real funeral all know what is meant by "the brotherhood of man." When they paid their little share of the fund, they paid their "brotherhood dues." And the men who did this—who gave something willingly because they felt that they should, were:

John N. Sievers, George C. Brownell, George H. Bannan, W. A. Dimick, W. L. Mulvey, Grant B. Dimick, O. W. Eastham, Harvey E. Cross, Charles Schram, E. T. Mass, William J. Wilson, S. O. Dillman, Dr. L. A. Morris, O. D. Eby, Dr. H. S. Mount, L. Adams and W. A. Long.

They all belong to the brotherhood of man, and they know what the brotherhood means.

## ONE WAY OUT

Senator Chamberlain has introduced a bill for the settlement of the Oregon & California land grant tangle that appears to be the best solution yet offered for the predicament in which the state of Oregon finds itself. In brief the bill provides that the Oregon & California lands shall be disposed of to bona fide purchasers and settlers, that no part of it shall be locked up in reserves, that the railroad company shall get two and a half dollars an acre for the land; and that of the sum realized by its sale later to the people, twenty percent shall go to the Federal government, forty percent shall go to the state of Oregon for the common school fund, and forty percent shall be given to the land grant counties for the improvement of roads and highways.

According to the Chamberlain bill the government is to buy the lands from the Southern Pacific (the successor of the original Oregon & California railroad) for the flat price of \$2.50 an acre stipulated in the original grant. After this purchase the government shall classify the lands into mineral, timber and agricultural; and the timber on the "timber land" shall be sold before these lands themselves are disposed of. The sale of the land itself is to be through federal agencies, and sufficient safeguards are provided by the plan to prevent speculation.

The bill probably offers as good a

way out of the land tangle in Oregon as any that has yet been suggested, or that will be suggested. The state of Oregon will receive a very great increase to its school fund, if the bill carries; and the land grant counties will have enough road money to get some much needed highways. These two provisions have probably been inserted in the measure to bring it friends in great number—but the disposal of the sums realized from the sale of the lands is good, even at that. The government's 20 percent will help defray the cost of the federal purchase and of federal work in clearing the matter up.

The bill also seems to slip a few stumbling blocks in the path of S. A. D. Puter and some other professional gentlemen who have been busily engaged in "protecting" settlers on the grant lands, for it provides that the only prior claims that will be recognized are those made by people who were actually living on the land in December of 1915, and who have resided there ever since. In short the bill appears to be a good way of getting the most out of a bad tangle, and congress should be given encouragement to pass it.

## MEBBES, MEBBES

Right at the start of this we beg pardon for using the colloquialism at the head of this, but it most clearly expresses our thoughts in the matter. And now to get down to the question in hand.

The Honorable Christian Schuebel, ably assisted and confirmed by some other people, says that the Courier has no right to "butt in" to the republican primaries. Mr. Schuebel avers that the Courier is a democratic paper, and that until the primaries

on the men themselves, and not upon them as republican nominees—or as republican aspirants.

These few remarks are made right here, in ample time before the primary election, so that republicans who think the same way that the Honorable Christian Schuebel thinks need not be incensed or surprised if this paper "butts in" to the republican primaries, and says a few kind words about the men—MEN, mind you, who are seeking office. When the Courier obtains facts about a MAN who is running for office; and when these facts ought to be known by the people before the man is voted upon, the Courier is going to shoot 'em out—even if the man in the case is a republican.

## MEXICO

Right at this time it is well to face matters squarely, and not to conceal meanings in flowery words. There are just three possible explanations of the event that led up to the invasion of Mexico by a punitive expedition of the United States Army. Villa attacked Columbus, New Mexico, for one of three reasons: he was desperate and in sight of immediate defeat, so made the attack knowing that the United States would take steps against him, and that any such attack by Americans would make him appear a hero in the eyes of Mexicans and so increase his following and resources. Or else he was urged and encouraged to make the attack by certain agents of the European government that is trying desperately to plunge the United States into some sort of trouble, so that Uncle Sam will have too much on his hands to longer watch Europe. Or his attack was instigated by cer-

meanwhile, the situation is serious enough to demand the deep thought of every American citizen.

## BRIGHT EYES WANTED

A couple of weeks ago the Courier expressed the fond wish that some councilman of the calibre of Mr. Moore would express a curiosity as to the meaning of that wire fence on the western side of Water street, between Sixth and the Suspension bridge. As yet the Courier hasn't heard of any councilman's curiosity in the matter. And, in fact, it really didn't expect that there would be any manifested.

However, considering that this is nearly half of Oregon City's free and unreserved water front, and that assaults have already been made on other parts of the city's right to reach the river; it would seem that this fence ought to be a subject of considerable inquiry. When, some weeks ago, an ordinance was slipped into the council establishing the grade of that imaginary part of Water street that lies in deep water, and when the same ordinance would—had it passed—have established the grade of the west end of Twelfth street, too; it was the bright eye of Councilman Moore who saw the hidden plot therein, and who promptly started agitation that blocked the ordinance. And it was Councilman Moore who asked that the ordinance itself be investigated.

Councilman Moore's bright eyes are to be congratulated. Likewise are the eyes of Mayor Hackett, which at once saw the point raised by Mr. Moore. Between the two of them, the mayor and the alert councilman should be able to do considerable—especially as Mr. Moore usually votes with the administration and

Violets, candidates' cards, general laziness, building activity and interest in fishing all prove that spring has come.

A Portland department store advertises "new rompers, 59 cents." Do they usually sell old rompers, we wonder?

Some people were green in the county seat on St. Patrick's Day, and some wore orange—but we didn't hear of any fights.

Nobody ought to doubt the county seat's enthusiasm for preparedness—just look at the candidates who want "to save the country."

One of the hardest tasks confronting a candidate for office is to manufacture a good "talking point" for the primary campaign.

Another sign of spring that is to be observed is the general inclination to get out and "do something to that road."

If you want to vote, don't neglect to register before April 18. You have less than a month left to look after this matter.

This is the time of the year when wise people plant Oregon-grown seeds. Some people plant seeds that they get from their congressman, too.

Advertisers know that people read each page of the Courier. And Courier readers know that people who have good things to sell advertise in the paper that has a larger circulation than all other Clackamas county papers together.

T. Roosevelt says he is "willing" to lead America under certain conditions. Yes—and it was Jonathan Bourne who said Oregon was on trial last time, and not himself. And everybody knows what happened to Jonathan.

It is to be noted that while the Astoria naval base committee is still seeking a "hearing," the lower house of Congress has passed a bill giving over two million to the Puget Sound yard. They must pull together better in the Evergreen state.

Portland's schools, having passed safely through the last charge of faulty teaching methods, are now facing new charges of favoritism in appointments. As we've before remarked, Portland seems to have lots of trouble with her schools.

The imports of beer and liquor seem to increase, rather than decrease. And we hear less crowing from certain quarters about the benefits of Oregon's dry law. Which reminds us that it was the "wets" in the recent campaign who remarked: "you can't legislate reform into a man."

## WORK LINED UP

April Grand Jury Will Probe Evidence Regarding Liquor Violations

The April grand jury has a nice lot of work already lined up for it. Aside from the usual run of cases, the inquirers will be given a list of alleged liquor law violations to study over, and it is expected that a number of interesting indictments will be returned. Members of the force of the sheriff's office have been gathering information on this subject and the district attorney's office has also been looking into matters of this sort. All the evidence secured will be laid before the grand jury.

While neither the sheriff nor the district attorney would give any hint of what they have, it is believed that sufficient evidence has been accumulated to make life exciting in Clackamas county for some of the law violators after the grand jury makes its report.

## HIGHLAND

(Too Late for Regular Page)

Mr. Washburn was buying seed oats of Mr. Cornwell last week. Mrs. C. C. Kandle was over visiting and doing a little dressmaking for Mrs. Cornwell last week.

Lloyd Schram expects to bring a crowd of young folks out to the dance at Clarkes on the first. They will make the trip in his auto truck, and those wanting to ride must speak early.

Mrs. Cash, of Beaver Creek, was visiting her sister, Mrs. Sims, over Sunday.

The two Mrs. Clarkes have been keeping bachelor maids' hall on Mrs. Hehn's place, while their men put in the crop on the LaVall place, which they have rented.

The Martin brothers have been hauling plank out on to the road to be used to get over some of the mud we have. We understand they will soon move their mill over near El-

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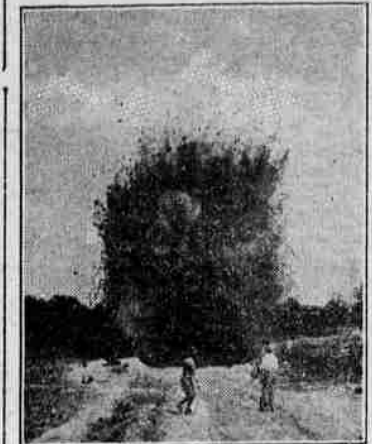
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## Explosives in Road Building

One of the newer methods of road building that is fast winning the endorsement of the better versed contractor is that of employing dynamite for reducing the heavy work.

Grading through hard ground or rock, for instance, is tedious and requires time and labor. The use of dynamite for blasting such material is a welcome relief. Both rock and hard clay may be loosened in the cut by well placed charges of explosives if holes are drilled into the ground a little way up the bank and loaded. Careful spacing and loading for electrically fired blasts will result in bringing down both classes of materials in the best possible manner.



In loosening shale and rock to facilitate hand or steam shovel work dynamite is also very effective, while stumps may be blasted from the roadside just as though they were being removed from a field to be cleared and cultivated.

Boulders also are easily shattered by suitable loading and when of hard rock may be crushed into surface. The side ditches can also be blasted in keeping with the nature of the ground. In fact, there are no limits practically to the many uses and advantages of dynamite for road building when careful and thoughtful attention is given to the work.

Incidentally the planting of shade trees for roadside improvement and attractiveness is greatly facilitated by the judicious use of a little dynamite. It is a recognized fact that trees planted in blasted holes grow much more rapidly and progress more favorably than those planted in the average spending ground.

wood to saw out road plank, for which they have a contract with the county.

George Hanson, who is in a logging camp near Aberdeen, reports, in a letter, that times and wages are good there.

Mr. and Mrs. Dickson, of Oswego, expect to visit our grange at our next meeting, if the weather will permit, so all good grangers should be present at the grange that day.

## MARINE MILITIA FORMED

Three States Have Volunteer Corps Which Act as Reserves

Marine Militia companies of three states, Ohio, Illinois, and California, are forming to augment the force of U. S. Marines in time of war. The United States Marine Corps, consisting of but 9,921 men, has no reserve force other than one Marine Militia Company in Massachusetts and another in Louisiana.

The Marine Militiamen will be trained in the duties of the U. S. Marine regular, ashore and afloat, and will be attached to the several state naval militia organizations.

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are come and past that we should ignore such republican luminaries as are poking up their heads for the electorate to swat. After the primaries, when republican and democratic candidates are aligned in battle array, then, Mr. Schuebel admits, the Courier may rightfully take a paste at such republican heads as it doesn't admire.

We can well understand why the Honorable Christian Schuebel and some other registered republicans so opine. The republicans have grief enough on their hands before the primaries, and they don't like to have the Courier add any more trouble. And if politics in this great state of Oregon was simply a matter of party caucuses and party slates, the Schuebel et al contention would be perfectly good.

However, the time has gone by in Oregon when people will vote for either a man or a yellow dog just because he has a party affiliation label tacked on to him. Here in Oregon political affiliations don't count for much—for this is a state that is "overwhelmingly republican," but which has a habit of returning democratic men to office. People hereabouts vote for the MAN, and not for the party; so the Courier construes it as its duty, as a newspaper, to occasionally pass comment upon some of the men who are "running for office," even before the primaries. The Courier, when it does this, is commenting

tain American business interests that hope to see intervention into Mexico, knowing that under American rule or protection their Mexican concessions will greatly increase in value.

The Courier is inclined to believe that Villa made his attack for the first of the reasons enumerated. If Villa can appear to the Mexican people as a man who is being persecuted by a foreign and invading power, he will not only gain followers and sympathy; but he may in time rally all Mexico to his defense by making the ignorant Mexicans believe that the United States is after Mexico and not after Villa.

However, the other two reasons are plausible enough to demand consideration—and when the time comes, action.

In the meantime, two results of the chase after Villa loom before the American people. If Villa is caught immediately, the incident will probably be closed without further trouble of a serious nature. If Villa is not caught in a very short space of time, he will become a national hero in Mexico, will gain sufficient sympathy to undermine the Carranza government (which is none too secure), and the United States will have a war with Mexico on its hands.

The Courier trusts that the American soldiers will meet with early success in their pursuit of Villa. In the

against the insurgent faction.

Hence the Courier has the temerity once again to speak of that fence on the western side of Water street, from Sixth street north, and to hope fondly that the council will get actively curious about it. This is a good time to probe that fence and what is back of it—for before very many months have passed it will be too late. And when it is too late, Oregon City will have still less free and available water frontage than it has now.

If the council doesn't investigate that fence, the Courier may make a guess as to why it doesn't.

Nice weather we're having: it hatches out the flies, mosquitos and spiders.

If you want to hear something choice, ask Billy Wilson what he thinks of the newspapers.

The campaign for constable in these parts promises to be about the hottest fight of the primaries.

It is a remarkable thing that in "dry" Oregon almost every man carries an "opener" on his key-ring.

Registration closes for most of us April 18. Are you going to wait till then before you get ready to vote?

The President has approved the plan to recruit the army to its full strength. Preparedness is the thing.